

KINGDOM LIFE MINISTRY

The Day of Atonement

Yom Kippur, the blood that went behind the veil, and what the day asks of you now

Scripture from the World English Bible, divine name rendered YHWH, Elohim, and Adonai.

THE HEART OF IT. The sacrifice is finished. The appointment is not. YHWH put this day on His own calendar and called it a statute forever, and nothing about the cross cancelled a day that the cross fulfilled.

A free printable teaching handout from Kingdom Life Ministry.

BEFORE YOU BEGIN

What This Is and What It Is Not

This is a walk through what Scripture actually says about the Day of Atonement, from Leviticus to Hebrews, and then an honest look at what is left for us to do with a day whose sacrifice has already been made. Read the passages yourself as you go. If anything here does not match the text, go with the text.

- This is not a Jewish holiday that outsiders are allowed to borrow. It is one of YHWH's appointed times, listed in Leviticus 23 in the same breath as the Sabbath.
- Nothing in here earns you anything. The atonement was finished at the cross. Keeping the appointment is obedience and remembrance, never payment.
- The day runs evening to evening, so it starts at sundown the night before and ends at sundown the next day.
- No rabbinic fence rules are in here. Only what the text says.

If you come into this day holding unforgiveness against somebody, you can fast twenty five hours and change nothing. Deal with that first. Everything else in this handout depends on it.

PART I

The Day YHWH Set

Before anything about goats or blood or fasting, settle whose day this is and who decided it.

1. An Appointed Time, Not a Holiday

Leviticus 23 is YHWH's own calendar. He does not call these the feasts of Israel or the feasts of the Jews. He calls them His. That one detail settles most of the arguments people have about whether any of this is for them. A day does not belong to a people group. It belongs to the One who set it.

Speak to the children of Israel, and tell them, The set feasts of YHWH, which you shall proclaim to be holy convocations, even these are my set feasts.

Leviticus 23:2

2. The Tenth Day of the Seventh Month

Ten days after the trumpet blast of Yom Teruah comes the tenth day. The instruction has three parts and they are not complicated. Gather. Afflict yourself. Do no work. Notice that the gathering is commanded before the afflicting is, which tells you something about how this day was meant to be kept. Not alone in a dark room.

However on the tenth day of this seventh month is the day of atonement. It shall be a holy convocation to you. You shall afflict yourselves and you shall offer an offering made by fire to YHWH. You shall do no kind of work in that same day, for it is a day of atonement, to make atonement for you before YHWH your Elohim.

Leviticus 23:27-28

3. Evening to Evening, and Forever

The clock and the duration are both spelled out. The day begins the evening before, and the instruction is not given an expiration date. Whatever you conclude about how it is kept now, you cannot get to the conclusion that YHWH quietly withdrew it.

It shall be a Sabbath of solemn rest for you, and you shall deny yourselves. In the ninth day of the month at evening, from evening to evening, you shall keep your Sabbath.

Leviticus 23:32

You shall do no kind of work: it is a statute forever throughout your generations in all your dwellings.

Leviticus 23:31

PART II

Inside the Veil

Leviticus 16 is the instruction manual for the day. Read it slowly, because every piece of it is pointing at something.

One man. One day a year. One way in. And he could not stay.

4. One Man, One Day, One Way

Access to the presence of YHWH was not casual and it was not open. The high priest could not wander in whenever he felt moved to. There was a day, and outside that day the answer was no, and the penalty for getting it wrong was death. Hold onto that, because it makes what happens later hit the way it should.

YHWH said to Moses, Tell Aaron your brother not to come at just any time into the Most Holy Place within the veil, before the mercy seat which is on the ark, lest he die; for I will appear in the cloud on the mercy seat.

Leviticus 16:2

5. Two Goats, One Picture

Two goats, identical, standing side by side. Lots are cast. One is for YHWH and one is sent away. People argue about which one pictures Messiah, and the answer is both, because one animal could not carry the whole picture. One dies. One carries it off. Yahshua did both.

He shall take the two goats and set them before YHWH at the door of the Tent of Meeting. Aaron shall cast lots for the two goats: one lot for YHWH, and the other lot for the scapegoat.

Leviticus 16:7-8

6. The Blood on the Mercy Seat

The blood does not stay at the altar in the courtyard. It goes in, past the veil, to the one place no one was allowed, and it is put on the lid of the ark. The mercy seat sits directly over the tablets of the covenant we broke. Blood between the broken instructions and the presence of YHWH. That is the whole gospel in one piece of furniture.

Then he shall kill the goat of the sin offering that is for the people, and bring his blood within the veil, and do with his blood as he did with the blood of the bull, and sprinkle it on the mercy seat and before the mercy seat.

Leviticus 16:15

7. The Goat That Carried It Away

This is the part people forget. Sin was not only paid for, it was carried off. Hands laid on the head, the iniquities confessed out loud over the animal, and then the animal walks away with them into a place no one goes. Forgiveness that is only legal leaves you still carrying it. YHWH sent it away.

Aaron shall lay both his hands on the head of the live goat, and confess over him all the iniquities of the children of Israel, and all their transgressions, even all their sins; and he shall put them on the head of the goat, and shall send him away into the wilderness. The goat shall carry all their iniquities on himself to a solitary land.

Leviticus 16:21-22

As far as the east is from the west, so far has he removed our transgressions from us.

Psalms 103:12

8. Clean Before YHWH

Here is the point of the whole day, stated plainly in one verse. Not forgiven and still filthy. Clean. That word is the one to carry into the rest of this handout.

for on this day shall atonement be made for you, to cleanse you. You shall be clean from all your sins before YHWH.

Leviticus 16:30

PART III

The Better Sacrifice

Hebrews was written to people who knew this day by heart. The writer does not explain the ceremony, he assumes it, and then shows what it was always pointing at.

The high priest went in once a year and came straight back out. Yahshua went in once and sat down. A priest who sits is a priest whose work is finished.

9. The Greater Tabernacle

The tent in the wilderness was a copy. The blood of goats was a placeholder. Yahshua walked into the real one, and He did not bring an animal. He brought Himself, which is the one thing no high priest before Him could do.

But Messiah having come as a high priest of the coming good things, through the greater and more perfect tabernacle, not made with hands, that is to say, not of this creation, nor yet through the blood of goats and calves, but through his own blood, entered in once for all into the Holy Place, having obtained eternal redemption.

Hebrews 9:11-12

10. Once, Not Year After Year

A sacrifice you have to repeat every year is a reminder that last year's did not finish the job. The writer says so outright. The blood of animals never took away a single sin. It covered and it pointed forward, and it did that faithfully for centuries, until the thing it pointed at showed up.

But in those sacrifices there is a yearly reminder of sins. For it is impossible that the blood of bulls and goats should take away sins.

Hebrews 10:3-4

Every priest indeed stands day by day serving and often offering the same sacrifices, which can never take away sins, but he, when he had offered one sacrifice for sins forever, sat down on the right hand of Elohim.

Hebrews 10:11-12

11. The Veil Torn From the Top

The veil was the whole reason for the day. One man, once a year, and everybody else stayed out. When Yahshua died that veil came apart, and the direction matters. From the top down. No man reached up and tore it. The way in was opened from the inside.

Behold, the veil of the temple was torn in two from the top to the bottom.

Matthew 27:51

For by one offering he has perfected forever those who are being sanctified.

Hebrews 10:14

PART IV

What the Day Asks Now

So if the sacrifice is finished, what is left? This is where most teaching on this day either quits early or goes back under a yoke. Neither one is necessary.

Colossians 2:16 is not a permission slip to ignore the appointed times. Read the whole sentence. It says do not let anyone judge you about how you keep them, and then calls them a shadow of things to come. A shadow proves there is a body casting it.

12. The Sacrifice Is Finished, the Appointment Is Not

Paul's point is that outsiders do not get a vote on how you keep a feast. He does not say the feast is gone. He says the substance belongs to Messiah, which is exactly why we still look at the shadow. It is His outline. We keep the day because it is His, not because our keeping it accomplishes atonement. That was settled on a Roman cross.

Let no one therefore judge you in eating or drinking, or with respect to a feast day or a new moon or a Sabbath day, which are a shadow of the things to come; but the body is Messiah's.

Colossians 2:16-17

When much time had passed and the voyage was now dangerous because the Fast had now already gone by...

Acts 27:9

13. Afflict Your Soul

The Hebrew phrase is to humble or deny yourself. Israel understood it as a fast, and it has been kept as a fast ever since. But it was never only the empty stomach. It is the posture the empty stomach is supposed to produce. Take the food away and whatever was underneath comes up, which is the point of doing it.

It shall be a statute to you forever: in the seventh month, on the tenth day of the month, you shall afflict your souls, and shall do no kind of work.

Leviticus 16:29

14. The Fast YHWH Chooses

Isaiah 58 is the correction YHWH gave to people who fasted correctly and stayed the same. They went without food, they made sure He noticed, and they went right on running over people. He tells them plainly what He was after. If you fast all day and there is somebody you are still holding down, you missed it.

Why have we fasted, they say, and you don't see? Why have we afflicted our soul, and you don't notice? Behold, in the day of your fast you find pleasure, and oppress all your laborers.

Isaiah 58:3

Isn't this the fast that I have chosen: to release the bonds of wickedness, to undo the straps of the yoke, to let the oppressed go free, and that you break every yoke? Isn't it to distribute your bread to the hungry, and that you bring the poor who are cast out to your house?

Isaiah 58:6-7

15. Tear Your Heart

Tearing your clothes was the visible sign of grief, and it was easy. Anybody can ruin a shirt. YHWH asks for the thing underneath the shirt, which nobody else can see and nobody else can verify. That is the whole difference between a religious day and a real one.

Yet even now, says YHWH, turn to me with all your heart, and with fasting, and with weeping, and with mourning. Tear your heart and not your garments, and turn to YHWH, your Elohim; for he is gracious and merciful, slow to anger, and abundant in loving kindness.

Joel 2:12-13

16. When You Fast, Not If

Yahshua assumed His followers would fast. He did not command a schedule and He did not abolish the practice. He corrected the audience. Fasting done so that people can see you fasting has already been paid in full, in the currency you chose.

Moreover when you fast, don't be like the hypocrites, with sad faces. But you, when you fast, anoint your head and wash your face, so that you are not seen by men to be fasting, but by your Father who is in secret.

Matthew 6:16-18

17. The Thing That Actually Blocks It

Here is where this day and everything we teach meet. You cannot come to the Day of Atonement asking to be forgiven while refusing to forgive somebody else. Yahshua made that conditional and He did not soften it. And if you know somebody has something against you, He says stop what you are doing and go fix it before you bring the offering. Pride is what keeps us from doing that. Humility is what gets it done.

For if you forgive men their trespasses, your heavenly Father will also forgive you. But if you don't forgive men their trespasses, neither will your Father forgive your trespasses.

Matthew 6:14-15

If therefore you are offering your gift at the altar, and there remember that your brother has anything against you, leave your gift there before the altar, and go your way. First be reconciled to your brother, and then come and offer your gift.

Matthew 5:23-24

PART V

How We Keep It

This is what our house does. It is not a rule for yours. Take what is useful and leave the rest.

18. Repent, Fast, Fellowship

We repent, we fast, and we fellowship with others. Those three, in that order, and the last one is not filler. The instruction called for a holy convocation, which means gathered, and a day meant to be kept together has a way of going sour when it is kept alone. Confession out loud to another believer does something that silent confession does not, and there is no shortage of Scripture behind that.

If we confess our sins, he is faithful and righteous to forgive us the sins and to cleanse us from all unrighteousness.

1 John 1:9

Confess your offenses to one another and pray for one another, that you may be healed. The insistent prayer of a righteous person is powerfully effective.

James 5:16

19. If You Have Never Done This Before

Start at sundown the night before and go to sundown the next day. Drink water. If a medical condition makes fasting food unwise, fast something else and do not let anyone put guilt on you for it, because the point was never the hunger. Put the phone down. Read Leviticus 16 and Hebrews 9 and 10 straight through. Write down the names of people you need to forgive and the people you need to go to. Then actually go to them. Break the fast with other believers if you can.

Then your light will break out as the morning, and your healing will appear quickly; then your righteousness shall go before you, and YHWH's glory will be your rear guard.

Isaiah 58:8

REFERENCE

Cross Reference Index

SCRIPTURE	PRAYER
Psalms 103:12	Section 7
Isaiah 58:3	Section 14
Isaiah 58:6-7	Section 14
Isaiah 58:8	Section 19
Joel 2:12-13	Section 15
Matthew 5:23-24	Section 17
Matthew 6:14-15	Section 17
Matthew 6:16-18	Section 16
Matthew 27:51	Section 11
Colossians 2:16-17	Section 12
Hebrews 9:11-12	Section 9
Hebrews 10:3-4	Section 10
Hebrews 10:11-12	Section 10
Hebrews 10:14	Section 11
James 5:16	Section 18
1 John 1:9	Section 18
Leviticus 16:2	Section 4
Leviticus 16:7-8	Section 5
Leviticus 16:15	Section 6
Leviticus 16:21-22	Section 7
Leviticus 16:29	Section 13
Leviticus 16:30	Section 8
Leviticus 23:2	Section 1
Leviticus 23:27-28	Section 2
Leviticus 23:31	Section 3
Leviticus 23:32	Section 3
Acts 27:9	Section 12

Every prayer in this guide is anchored to Scripture. If you disagree with something written here, go to the text and let the text settle it.

Notes

The high priest walked out of that tent every year knowing he would be back. You do not have a year's grace period that runs out. You have a finished work and a standing invitation, and one day on the calendar to stop and remember what it cost.

Kingdom Life Ministry

Restoring YHWH's design for marriage, family, forgiveness, and deliverance.

Walk in truth, walk in light. Shalom.